12-Month Placement Preparation Plan

Target: Product company offer in Data Analyst / ML Engineer / Data Scientist / SDE-AI role **Current baseline:** Python comfortable, basic DSA, Pandas/NumPy, 2 ML projects, weak SQL & System Design **Time budget:** 2 hrs/weekday × 5 + 8 hrs/weekend × 2 = **34 hrs/week ≈ 1,700 hrs/year**

The 4 Phases at a Glance

Phase	Months	Focus	Weekly Hour Split
1. Foundation	1–3	DSA, SQL, Python/OOP, Math, Andrew Ng ML, Core CS basics	DSA 10 / ML 6 / SQL 4 / Math 3 / OOP 3 / Core CS 3 / Aptitude 2 / Soft 3
2. Skill-Building	4–6	DL, Advanced DSA, full Core CS, System Design basics	DSA 10 / DL 10 / Core CS 4 / SysDes 3 / Project 5 / Aptitude 2
3. Portfolio	7–9	3 deployable projects, LLMs/RAG, early applications	DSA 8 / Projects 12 / GenAI 6 / SysDes 4 / Resume 2 / Mock 2
4. Interview Grind	10–12	Mock interviews, company-tagged DSA, apply aggressively	DSA 12 / Mock 8 / Revision 8 / Behavioral 3 / Applications 3

Phase 1 — Foundation (Months 1–3)

Month 1 — DSA basics + SQL kickoff + Andrew Ng Course 1

Goal: Arrays/strings/hashing fluent. SQL joins comfortable. First ML course's first half done. Daily routine locked in.

Hours target: ~140 hrs

Weekly milestones

- **Week 1:** Set up LeetCode/GitHub/Notion. 10 LeetCode easy (arrays). Andrew Ng Week 1. DataLemur SQL: 10 easy. Start daily aptitude (IndiaBix 20 q).
- **Week 2:** 15 LeetCode (arrays+hashing). Andrew Ng Week 2. DataLemur: 10 more. Start Love Babbar DBMS playlist (ER model, relational model).
- **Week 3:** 15 LeetCode (strings). Andrew Ng Week 3 (logistic regression). SQL: joins + subqueries.
- **Week 4:** 10 LeetCode (review + mixed). Andrew Ng Course 1 finish. DBMS: normalization. OOP refresh with Corey Schafer.

Weekday template (2 hrs)

- 6:45–7:30 AM — 2 LeetCode easy problems (Striver sheet, current topic)
- 6:00–7:15 PM — Andrew Ng video + quiz + note-taking
- 9:00–9:30 PM — DBMS video OR OOP exercise

Saturday template (8 hrs)

- 7:00–10:00 AM — 5 LeetCode problems (mix of week's topics)
- 10:30 AM–12:30 PM — SQL on DataLemur
- 2:00–4:00 PM — Andrew Ng assignments + notes
- 4:00–5:00 PM — Aptitude (IndiaBix, 1 hr focused block)
- 5:00–6:00 PM — DBMS video
- 7:00–8:00 PM — Record yourself answering "Tell me about yourself" for 3 min

Sunday template (8 hrs)

- 7:00–10:00 AM — Hard LeetCode (2 mediums)
- 10:30 AM–12:30 PM — Project 1 planning (pick dataset, sketch architecture)
- 2:00–4:00 PM — Andrew Ng + Khan Academy stats
- 4:00–5:00 PM — OOP (Corey Schafer episodes)
- 5:00–6:00 PM — Long aptitude set (50 questions timed)
- 7:00–8:00 PM — **Weekly review**: What did I finish? What slipped? Next week's top 3 priorities

End-of-Month-1 checklist

- ☐ 50 LeetCode problems solved
- ☐ Andrew Ng Course 1 complete (Supervised Learning)
- ☐ 30 SQL problems on DataLemur
- ☐ DBMS: ER + Relational + Normalization covered
- ☐ 500+ aptitude questions attempted
- ☐ GitHub profile set up with pinned placeholder
- ☐ 10+ Corey Schafer Python OOP videos watched
- ☐ Project 1: dataset downloaded, notebook scaffolded

Month 2 — More DSA + SQL windows + ML Course 2

Goal: Linked lists, stacks, queues, binary search solid. SQL window functions comfortable. Andrew Ng Course 2 done. OOP done.

Hours target: ~140 hrs

Weekly milestones

- **Week 5:** 15 LeetCode (linked lists). Andrew Ng C2 Week 1. SQL: window functions intro.
- **Week 6:** 15 LeetCode (stacks, queues). Andrew Ng C2 Week 2. SQL: partition, rank, lead/lag.
- **Week 7:** 15 LeetCode (binary search). Andrew Ng C2 Week 3 (advanced algorithms). OOP deep dive.
- **Week 8:** 15 LeetCode (recursion). Andrew Ng C2 finish. SQL CTEs. OS: intro (processes, threads).

Weekday template (same structure as Month 1, topic rotated)

- Morning DSA (2 problems) → Evening ML → Night CS/OOP

Saturday template

- DSA 3 hrs → SQL 2 hrs → ML 2 hrs → Aptitude 1 hr

Sunday template

- DSA 3 hrs → Project 1 work (2 hrs) → ML lab (2 hrs) → OS/Math 1 hr

End-of-Month-2 checklist

- ☐ 100 LeetCode problems total
- ☐ Andrew Ng Course 2 complete (Advanced Algorithms)
- ☐ SQL window functions + CTE comfortable
- ☐ 50 DataLemur problems total
- ☐ OOP: inheritance, polymorphism, composition, SOLID basics done
- ☐ OS: processes/threads covered
- ☐ Project 1: baseline model trained, evaluated (notebook form)
- ☐ Resume draft v0 (Jake's LaTeX template)

Month 3 — Trees/Graphs intro + ML Course 3 + Ship Project 1

Goal: Trees & BST comfortable. Andrew Ng specialization fully complete. Project 1 deployed with a URL. OS fundamentals done.

Hours target: ~150 hrs

Weekly milestones

- **Week 9:** Binary trees (15 LeetCode). Andrew Ng C3 W1 (unsupervised). Project 1: convert notebook → FastAPI.
- **Week 10:** BST + recursion on trees (15 LeetCode). Andrew Ng C3 W2 (recommender systems). Project 1: add Streamlit UI.
- **Week 11:** Heap + priority queue (10 LeetCode). Andrew Ng C3 W3. Deploy Project 1 (Render/HF Spaces).
- **Week 12:** Mixed revision (10 LeetCode). Wrap Andrew Ng. Month-3 self-test: full mock interview with a friend.

Weekday template

- Morning DSA → Evening ML/Project → Night OS

Saturday template

- DSA 3 hrs → Project 1 shipping work 3 hrs → Aptitude + OS 2 hrs

Sunday template

- DSA 3 hrs → Project 1 deploy + README 2 hrs → ML final 2 hrs → Weekly review 1 hr

End-of-Month-3 checklist

- ☐ 150 LeetCode problems
- ☐ Andrew Ng ML Specialization complete (certificate)
- ☐ Project 1 **live at a URL** with public GitHub + README
- ☐ OS: processes, memory, scheduling, IPC done
- ☐ DBMS: transactions, ACID, indexing done
- ☐ 70+ SQL problems

- ☐ LinkedIn profile live with photo, headline, About, 1 project post
- ☐ Took 1 mock interview (any friend, any topic)

Phase 2 — Skill-Building (Months 4–6)

Month 4 — DP intro + Deep Learning begins + Kaggle

Goal: Dynamic programming mental model clicking. DL Course 1 (Neural Networks) done. First Kaggle submission.

Hours target: ~150 hrs

Weekly milestones

- **Week 13:** DP 1D (15 LeetCode: climb stairs, house robber, coin change). Andrew Ng DL C1 W1-2. Kaggle: Titanic — submit baseline.
- **Week 14:** DP 2D (12 LeetCode: unique paths, LCS). DL C1 W3. Kaggle Titanic: iterate on feature engineering.
- **Week 15:** Greedy (10 LeetCode). DL C1 W4 (deep nets). Start *Hands-On ML* Chapters 1-3.
- **Week 16:** Mixed review (10 LeetCode). DL C1 finish. *Hands-On ML* Ch 4-5.

Weekday template

- Morning 2 LeetCode (DP focus) → Evening DL videos + labs → Night Hands-On ML reading

Saturday template

- DSA 3 hrs → DL labs / Kaggle 3 hrs → Aptitude 1 hr → Core CS 1 hr

Sunday template

- DSA 3 hrs → Kaggle submission work 2 hrs → ML book reading 2 hrs → CN intro 1 hr

End-of-Month-4 checklist

- ☐ 200 LeetCode problems
- ☐ Andrew Ng Deep Learning Course 1 complete
- ☐ Kaggle Titanic: submitted, top 50% of leaderboard
- ☐ *Hands-On ML* Chapters 1-5 read
- ☐ CN: OSI/TCP-IP layers covered
- ☐ 100 SQL problems total (StrataScratch mediums starting)
- ☐ Start Alex Xu System Design book — Ch 1-3

Month 5 — Trees/Graphs advanced + CNN/DL C2 + Project 2 begins

Goal: Graph algorithms (BFS/DFS/Dijkstra basics) solid. CNN intuition. Project 2 (DL) scaffolded.

Hours target: ~150 hrs

Weekly milestones

- **Week 17:** Graph traversal (12 LeetCode BFS/DFS). DL C2 (regularization, optimization). Project 2: pick dataset (medical imaging suggested).
- **Week 18:** Shortest path + topological sort (10 LeetCode). DL C2 finish. Project 2: baseline CNN trained.
- **Week 19:** Union-Find + MST (8 LeetCode). DL C3 (structuring ML projects). *Hands-On ML* Ch 9-10.
- **Week 20:** Mixed trees/graphs review (10 LeetCode). Transfer learning on Project 2. CN: TCP/UDP.

Weekday template

- Morning 2 LeetCode → Evening DL + Project 2 → Night CN

Saturday template

- DSA 3 hrs → Project 2 coding 3 hrs → System Design reading 1 hr → Aptitude 1 hr

Sunday template

- DSA 3 hrs → Project 2 training runs 2 hrs → DL book 2 hrs → Mock interview 1 hr

End-of-Month-5 checklist

- ☐ 250 LeetCode problems
- ☐ DL Courses 1-3 complete
- ☐ Project 2: trained model, clear metrics, Grad-CAM visualization
- ☐ *Hands-On ML* through Ch 11
- ☐ CN: routing, DNS, HTTP basics done
- ☐ 150 SQL problems
- ☐ 3 mock interviews done (peer or Pramp)

Month 6 — DP advanced + Transformers/RNN + Ship Project 2

Goal: DP comfortable on mediums. Transformer architecture understood. Project 2 deployed. System Design 5 classic designs done.

Hours target: ~160 hrs

Weekly milestones

- **Week 21:** DP on strings (edit distance, palindromes) — 12 LeetCode. DL C4 (CNNs deep dive).
- **Week 22:** Knapsack variants (10 LeetCode). DL C5 W1 (RNN + LSTM).
- **Week 23:** Hard graph problems (8 LeetCode). DL C5 W2-3 (Attention, Transformers). Ship Project 2 (deploy to HF Spaces).
- **Week 24:** Revision + 2 hard DSA. Kaggle: submit a 2nd competition. System Design: design URL shortener + chat app.

Weekday template

- DSA 1 hr (1 medium) → DL 1 hr

Saturday template

- DSA 3 hrs (hards now) → Project 2 deployment + README 3 hrs → System Design 2 hrs

Sunday template

- DSA 3 hrs → Kaggle 2 hrs → DL book 2 hrs → Weekly review + CN 1 hr

End-of-Month-6 checklist

- ☐ 300 LeetCode problems (Blind 75 done at least once)
- ☐ DL Specialization complete (certificate)
- ☐ *Hands-On ML* complete through Ch 17
- ☐ Project 2 **live at a URL** with deployment + README
- ☐ 2 Kaggle competitions submitted
- ☐ System Design: 5 classic designs drawn on paper (URL shortener, news feed, chat, Uber, YouTube)
- ☐ CN complete
- ☐ Resume v2: projects added, reviewed by 2 seniors

Phase 3 — Projects & Portfolio (Months 7–9)

Month 7 — LLMs/RAG + Project 3 starts + early applications

Goal: RAG app built. LangChain basics down. Start applying to summer/fresher roles.

Hours target: ~160 hrs

Weekly milestones

- **Week 25:** DeepLearning.AI LangChain short course. Project 3 scaffolding (RAG over PDFs). 10 LeetCode company-tagged.
- **Week 26:** DL.AI "Building Systems with ChatGPT API". Project 3: embeddings + vector DB (Chroma). 10 LeetCode.
- **Week 27:** HuggingFace course Ch 1-3. Project 3: LangChain retrieval chain + Streamlit UI. 10 LeetCode.
- **Week 28:** Project 3: deploy. Send first 5 referral requests on LinkedIn. 10 LeetCode.

Weekday template

- DSA 1 hr (company-tagged) → Project 3 1 hr

Saturday template

- DSA 2 hrs → Project 3 4 hrs → GenAI course 2 hrs

Sunday template

- DSA 2 hrs → Project 3 3 hrs → System Design Ch on ML systems 1 hr → LinkedIn/resume 1 hr → Mock interview 1 hr

End-of-Month-7 checklist

- ☐ 350 LeetCode problems
- ☐ LangChain + RAG concepts solid
- ☐ Project 3 (RAG app) **live with demo video**
- ☐ HuggingFace course: Ch 1-3

- ☐ Alex Xu Vol 1 half done
- ☐ Resume v3 finalized
- ☐ LinkedIn: 2 project posts, 50+ connections of relevant seniors
- ☐ 5 referral requests sent
- ☐ 5 mock interviews done

Month 8 — Project 4 + ML System Design + APPLY

Goal: Project 4 done (analytics dashboard). 50 applications submitted. ML System Design comfortable.

Hours target: ~170 hrs

Weekly milestones

- **Week 29:** Project 4: pick dataset (Zomato/Swiggy/food delivery), SQL-driven analysis. Start Chip Huyen's ML Systems book.
- **Week 30:** Project 4: PowerBI/Tableau dashboard. System Design: design Instagram feed. Apply to 15 roles.
- **Week 31:** Project 4: storytelling + insights blog post (Medium). ML System Design: design recommendation system. Apply to 15 more.
- **Week 32:** Project 4: polish, publish. Apply to 20 more. First 3 recruiter calls expected.

Weekday template

- DSA 1 hr → Project 4 / applications / ML book 1 hr

Saturday template

- DSA 2 hrs → Project 4 4 hrs → Applications + LinkedIn 2 hrs

Sunday template

- DSA 2 hrs → ML System Design 2 hrs → Mock interview 2 hrs → Apply to 5 roles 1 hr → Review 1 hr

End-of-Month-8 checklist

- ☐ 400 LeetCode
- ☐ Project 4 live with dashboard + Medium post
- ☐ Chip Huyen's *Designing ML Systems* Ch 1-6 read
- ☐ 50+ applications submitted (spreadsheet tracked)
- ☐ 10 referrals secured
- ☐ 10 mock interviews done
- ☐ Behavioral stories: 6 STAR stories written
- ☐ System Design: 8 classic designs known

Month 9 — Polish + Interviews start + Revision rounds

Goal: First real interviews happening. 600+ total LeetCode. Applications at 100+.

Hours target: ~170 hrs

Weekly milestones

- **Week 33:** Company-specific prep for any incoming interview. DSA company-tagged 15 problems.
- **Week 34:** ML systems revision. Behavioral practice recorded video daily.
- **Week 35:** SQL revision (all StrataScratch hards done). Apply to 20 more.
- **Week 36:** System Design: volume 2 topics. Apply to 20 more. Recruiter follow-ups.

Weekday template

- DSA 1 hr → Interview-prep-of-the-moment 1 hr

Saturday template

- DSA 2 hrs → Mock interview 2 hrs → Revision 2 hrs → Apply + outreach 2 hrs

Sunday template

- DSA 2 hrs → Full mock (Pramp 2 hrs) → System Design 2 hrs → Behavioral 1 hr → Review 1 hr

End-of-Month-9 checklist

- ☐ 450 LeetCode
- ☐ 100+ applications
- ☐ 15+ mock interviews
- ☐ First OA (online assessment) attempted
- ☐ First technical interview attended (even if rejected)
- ☐ STAR stories: 10+ polished
- ☐ Salary research done for each target company (Glassdoor/LeetCode compensations)

Phase 4 — Interview Grind (Months 10–12)

Month 10 — Heavy interview cadence begins

Goal: 3 interviews/week. Reject early ones as learning. Resume top patterns.

Hours target: ~170 hrs

Weekly milestones

- **Week 37:** Pattern review: sliding window, two-pointers, monotonic stack. 3 mocks.
- **Week 38:** Pattern review: trees/graphs. 3 mocks. 2 real interviews expected.
- **Week 39:** Pattern review: DP. 3 mocks. 2 real interviews.
- **Week 40:** Company-specific prep for confirmed interviews. 3 mocks.

Weekday template

- DSA 1 hr (revision) → Mock recording or System Design 1 hr

Saturday template

- DSA 2 hrs → Mock interviews 3 hrs → Behavioral + SQL 2 hrs → Apply 1 hr

Sunday template

- DSA 2 hrs → Mock 2 hrs → ML revision 2 hrs → System Design 1 hr → Week review 1 hr

End-of-Month-10 checklist

- ☐ 500 LeetCode
- ☐ 25 mock interviews done
- ☐ 8+ real interviews attended
- ☐ All Blind 75 + Neetcode 150 solved at least once
- ☐ Anki deck: 100+ ML concept cards reviewed daily

Month 11 — Convert + handle offers

Goal: First offers arriving. Negotiate. Keep applying — don't accept the first lowball.

Hours target: ~160 hrs

Weekly milestones

- **Week 41:** 3 mocks. 3 real interviews. Onsite prep (6+ rounds per company).
- **Week 42:** 3 mocks. Possibly first offer. Compare with others.
- **Week 43:** 3 mocks. Negotiate. Keep applying to backup offers.
- **Week 44:** 3 mocks. Final-round prep for tier-1 companies.

Weekday template

- Interview-specific prep 2 hrs

Saturday template

- DSA 2 hrs → Mocks 2 hrs → Behavioral + negotiation prep 2 hrs → Applications 2 hrs

Sunday template

- Mock 2 hrs → Revision 3 hrs → Apply 1 hr → Rest 2 hrs

End-of-Month-11 checklist

- ☐ 550 LeetCode
- ☐ 35 mock interviews
- ☐ 15+ real interviews
- ☐ First offer (or strong leads)
- ☐ Negotiation script practiced
- ☐ All 4 portfolio projects polished

Month 12 — Close + Prepare to start working

Goal: Accept best offer. Prep for job: the tech stack, the team, the product.

Hours target: ~140 hrs

Weekly milestones

- **Week 45:** Final-round onsites. 3 mocks.
- **Week 46:** Negotiate, decide. Start reading the accepted company's tech blog.
- **Week 47:** Rest a bit. Pre-onboarding learning.
- **Week 48:** Wrap up. College final submissions. Celebrate. Prep thank-you notes for seniors who helped.

End-of-Month-12 checklist

- ☐ Accepted an offer
- ☐ 600+ LeetCode
- ☐ 20+ real interviews attended
- ☐ All portfolio projects permanently pinned + documented
- ☐ Referral "thank you" notes sent to 10+ seniors
- ☐ LinkedIn updated with new role
- ☐ Notes on interview experiences shared with juniors (pay it forward)

The 4 Portfolio Projects

#	Title	Stack	Skill it shows
1	House Price Predictor API	scikit-learn, FastAPI, Streamlit, Docker, Render	End-to-end ML + deployment
2	Medical X-Ray Classifier	PyTorch, CNN, transfer learning, Grad-CAM, HF Spaces	Deep Learning + model interpretability
3	Chat with your PDFs (RAG)	LangChain, Chroma/Pinecone, OpenAI API, Streamlit	LLMs + production GenAI
4	Food-Delivery Analytics Dashboard	SQL, Python ETL, PowerBI/Tableau, Medium blog	Data storytelling + analyst skill

Every project must have: live URL • public GitHub • README with problem/approach/results/run-instructions • architecture diagram • measurable metric.

Placement Strategy

When to apply

- **Campus:** whenever placement cell opens (month 7–10 typical)
- **Off-campus:** start month 8
- **Summer internships:** apply month 4–6 if relevant (PPO = game changer)

Channel mix

Channel	% effort	Conversion
Referrals	40%	Highest

Channel	% effort	Conversion
Campus	30%	High if shortlisted
Company career pages	15%	Moderate
LinkedIn Easy Apply	10%	Low but cheap
Startups (Wellfound)	5%	High learning

Cold referral template

> Hi {Name}, I'm a final-year CSE (AI/DS) student at {College}. I saw you work on {their team/product}. I recently built {Project 3 RAG app — 1-line summary + link}. {Company} is running my dream team, and I'm applying for {role}. Would you consider referring me? My resume is attached. Thank you!

Resources Cheat-Sheet

DSA

- **Striver's A2Z Sheet** (takeuforward.org) — primary
- **LeetCode** + **Blind 75** + **Neetcode 150**
- YouTube: takeuforward, Abdul Bari, Kevin Naughton Jr.

SQL

- **DataLemur** (free)
- **StrataScratch** (partially free)
- YouTube: Ankit Bansal's SQL series

ML

- Andrew Ng's ML + DL Specialization (Coursera, audit free)
- *Hands-On Machine Learning* — Aurélien Géron
- StatQuest with Josh Starmer (YouTube)

GenAI / LLMs

- DeepLearning.AI short courses (all free)
- HuggingFace Course
- LangChain official docs

System Design

- **ByteByteGo** (Alex Xu YouTube + book Vol 1 & 2)
- *Designing Machine Learning Systems* — Chip Huyen
- Gaurav Sen (YouTube)

Core CS

- Love Babbar CS Fundamentals (YouTube playlists for DBMS, OS, CN, OOP)

- Gate Smashers for quick revision

Aptitude

- IndiaBix, PrepInsta daily
- R.S. Aggarwal book (Quant + Verbal + Non-Verbal)

Math

- Khan Academy: Linear Algebra + Stats & Probability
- 3Blue1Brown "Essence of Linear Algebra" + "Essence of Calculus"
- *Think Stats* — Allen Downey (free PDF)

Mock Interviews

- **Pramp** (free peer mocks)
- **interviewing.io** (anonymous with professionals)
- Friends & seniors

Daily Routine (Realistic & Sustainable)

Weekday (Mon–Fri, 2 prod. hrs)

Time	Activity
6:30 AM	Wake, coffee, stretch
6:45–7:30 AM	DSA (2 problems)
7:30–8:15 AM	Breakfast + StatQuest/3B1B video
9 AM–4 PM	College — active listening, aptitude flashcards in breaks
4–5:30 PM	Rest/gym/social (non-negotiable)
6:00–7:15 PM	ML course / Project / SQL
9:00–9:30 PM	Core CS or System Design reading
9:30–10 PM	Journal: 3 wins + tomorrow's top 3
10:30 PM	Sleep (7.5 hrs non-negotiable)

Weekend (8 prod. hrs)

Time	Activity
7–10 AM	DSA (5–6 problems)
10:30 AM–12:30 PM	Project / Kaggle
2–4 PM	ML course content
4–5 PM	Mock interview or aptitude

Time	Activity
5–7 PM	Rest
7–8 PM	Weekly review (Sun) or aptitude (Sat)

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12 Common Mistakes Final-Year AI/DS Students Make

1. Tutorial hell: finishing 5 courses and doing 0 projects.
2. Treating DSA as optional because "I'm AI/ML".
3. Weak SQL — a killer for analyst roles.
4. Notebook-only projects with no deployment.
5. Skipping system design entirely.
6. Starting aptitude prep in month 11.
7. Applying too late — windows close in Jan/Feb for many product companies.
8. Only targeting "ML Engineer" — Data Analyst, Data Engineer pay well too.
9. No mock interviews until the week before.
10. Chasing LangChain/LLMs before understanding what cross-entropy loss is.
11. Not leveraging seniors for referrals.
12. Perfectionism on one project instead of shipping 3 imperfect ones.

How to Convert This File to PDF

Option A — Easiest (browser-based, no install)

1. Open `CAREER_PLAN_12_MONTHS.md` in **Visual Studio Code**.
2. Install the **Markdown PDF** extension (one click).
3. Right-click in the editor → **Markdown PDF: Export (pdf)**.
4. PDF saved alongside the .md file.

Option B — Online

1. Open https://md-to-pdf.fly.dev or https://cloudconvert.com/md-to-pdf
2. Upload or paste the .md content → Download PDF.

Option C — Pandoc (if installed)

```
pandoc CAREER_PLAN_12_MONTHS.md -o CAREER_PLAN_12_MONTHS.pdf \
  --pdf-engine=xelatex -V geometry:margin=1in
```

Option D — Google Docs (simplest for non-devs)

1. Open Google Docs → File → Open → Upload → pick the .md file.
2. It renders. File → Download → PDF.

Final Thought

Don't aim for perfection. Aim for **sustained weekly progress**. If you hit 70% of these milestones, you'll have an offer. The plan is not the work — executing is.

Start with today's Week 1, Day 1 task right now. The clock is ticking.

Good luck.